

Lookup and Reference Functions

A common task in data analysis is retrieving data from separate source tables/sheets for calculations and models. For this, Excel provides lookup and reference functions like:

VLOOKUP(): Searches and retrieves a value from a column in a table based on a matching criterion

CHOOSE(): Retrieves a value from a list of options based on a specified index number

INDEX-MATCH: A more versatile combination of INDEX and MATCH functions that can look up data across columns or rows dynamically

INDIRECT(): Retrieves a reference specified by a text string

OFFSET(): References a cell range relative to a specified anchor cell

HLOOKUP(): Same as above, but searches and retrieves from a row instead of column

These functions are powerful when combined with other functions to perform operations across larger datasets with minimal manual effort.